

THE QUESTION

How can Army use AI to increase operational effectiveness?

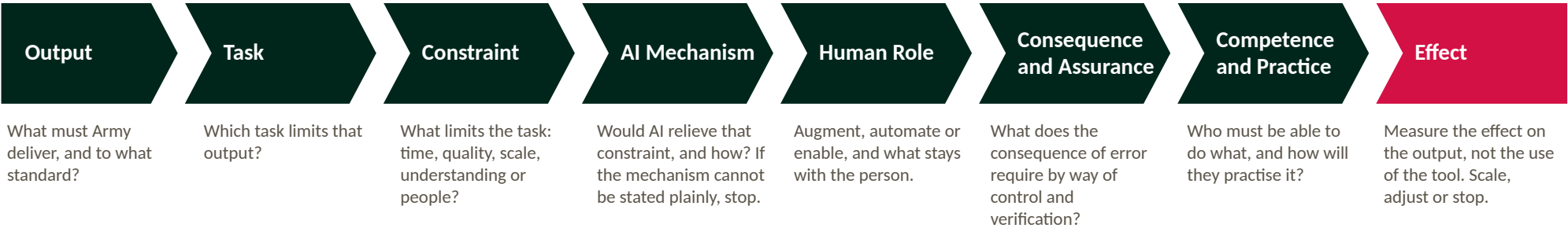
THE ANSWER

Army should use AI where it relieves the constraint on skilled human capacity in ways that convert into capability.

A small army that cannot fight when the tools are denied has not gained effectiveness. It has moved its dependence.

The Framework

Reason from the output to the tool. Close on measured effect.



An application that cannot answer Constraint and Mechanism is novelty. Measure the effect on the output, not the use of the tool.

CONSEQUENCE AND ASSURANCE ARE SETTLED BY A SINGLE TEST

Assurance increases with consequence, irreversibility and difficulty of verification

Where AI Creates Advantage

Five areas survive the test, ordered by the strength of the mechanism and how much of it Army controls.

Planning and staff work	Intelligence and readiness	Generating trained people	Learning and adaptation	Administrative load
Speed, breadth of options, staff time returned to judgement	Scale; understanding sooner, from more	Adaptive competence at scale; readiness	Speed of institutional learning	Human capacity
AUGMENT	AUGMENT; ENABLE FOR READINESS	AUGMENT AND ENABLE	ENABLE	AUTOMATE
Decides, accepts risk, verifies the product	Assesses sources, judges, decides	Coaches, assesses, assures the standard	Validates, decides what changes	Owns what is signed

Deliberately not prioritised: autonomous targeting, and personnel analytics ahead of the data to support them.

ARMY PEOPLE

Everyone understands it • Many employ it • Leaders govern it • A few specialise in it

The Principles

- 1

Effect first

AI is adopted where it improves an Army output, and is measured against that output.
- 2

Task before tool

Reason from the output and its constraint to the application, never from the technology to a use for it.
- 3

The commander owns it

AI advises, drafts and analyses; where consequence is high it does not decide. Verify what you use. You own what you sign.
- 4

Assurance by consequence

Control and verification increase with consequence, irreversibility and difficulty of verification.
- 5

Competence before dependence

No one relies on a tool for a skill they must perform without it when it matters. Competence comes from practice against real tasks, and is measured like any other.

Priority Actions

- 1

Own it

Assign accountability for AI in Army and set a risk appetite by consequence, so that low-consequence use on approved tools is enabled by default rather than blocked by default.
- 2

Prove effect in three places

Bounded, measured trials: planning and orders production in a headquarters; training design and feedback in Army Training Group; and readiness data integration. Measure effect on the output. Stop what does not work.
- 3

Train it through the approach

AI competence built into individual training against real tasks, with verification and tool-denied assurance of core skills. Instructors first.
- 4

Fix the data

Readiness and training data are the constraint on the highest-value application Army fully controls.
- 5

Compress the lessons cycle

Move from observation to updated training and tactics at a pace the force can act on.